

GENDER & SOCIETY

GE-ELECT2 | Module 1: Theoretical Foundations

Module 1: Foundations of Gender and Sexuality

This module introduces the fundamental distinctions between sex, gender, and sexuality. It explores how these concepts are constructed by society and how they influence our daily interactions and social structures.

Learning Objectives:

- Differentiate biological sex from socially constructed gender.
- Define gender identity and gender expression.
- Analyze the process of gender socialization through various agents.

Lesson 1.1: Distinguishing Sex, Gender, and Sexuality

Sex (Biological)	Biological characteristics such as chromosomes, hormones, and anatomy (Male, Female, Intersex).
Gender (Social)	Socially constructed roles and behaviors that society considers appropriate for men and women.
Sexuality	An individual's physical, romantic, and emotional attraction to others (e.g., Heterosexual, Bisexual, Pansexual).

Lesson 1.2: Identity vs. Expression

Understanding the "Internal" vs. the "External":

- **Gender Identity:** A person's internal sense of their own gender. This is how you feel inside.
- **Gender Expression:** How a person presents their gender to the world through clothing, behavior, and appearance.

Lesson 1.3: Gender as a Social Construct

We are not born with gender roles; we are socialized into them through **Agents of Socialization**:

- **The Family:** The primary source of gender learning (toys, chores, colors).
- **The Media:** Reinforces stereotypes through movies, ads, and social media.
- **The School:** Hidden curriculums that suggest different capabilities for boys and girls.

CRITICAL POINT: Gender is not a fixed biological trait; it is a "performance" shaped by cultural expectations that vary across time and geography.